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Customer Operations Transformation

Three Things We Can Make Faster

Without Touching Aurum or Replacing Your Dispatchers

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Acknowledging the Past

"Sarah, I know you've been burned twice — the chatbot customers hated, and the RPA that broke every time Aurum's schema changed."

What We're NOT Proposing

- ▶ Another chatbot that frustrates customers
- ▶ Brittle automation that breaks with system changes
- ▶ Vague "AI transformation" promises
- ▶ 18-month implementation before you see results

What We ARE Proposing

- ▶ **Three specific capabilities** that make your team faster
- ▶ **2-month pilot** to prove it works (then you decide: scale or stop)
- ▶ **Work within constraints** (Aurum's batch system, dispatcher judgment)

The Problem: Capacity vs. Growth

Current State: Customer Operations

35 FTE × 7.5 hours/day = **262.5 hours available**

730 cases/day across 4 work streams = **118 hours consumed**

73 hours/day (28%) on ETA inquiries alone

What Happens When Volume Grows 20%?

✗ Without Agent (Hire Proportionally)

- ▶ 480 ETA inquiries/day (up from 400)
- ▶ Need 88 hours/day (up from 73)
- ▶ **Hire 7 new FTE**
- ▶ **Cost: £280K/year**

✓ With Agent (Absorb Growth)

- ▶ 480 inquiries → 432 deflected (90%)
- ▶ Only 48 escalations to humans
- ▶ **Hire 0 new FTE**
- ▶ **Cost avoided: £280K/year**

Key Insight: ETA inquiries are high-volume, low-complexity work that scales linearly with delivery growth. This is exactly

The Problem: Hayes & Sons (6-Day Resolution)

Day 1, 09:14

Customer emails: "Remove £340 fuel surcharge on damaged delivery"

Day 1, 16:48

Billing team deflects: "Contact Customer Ops for goodwill credits"

↓ 3 days lost

Day 4, 11:02

Customer escalates: "On hold 22 min, dropped call. Second time this quarter. Who's your manager?"

↓ 2 days lost

Day 6, 15:30

Sandra resolves: "£170 goodwill credit applied"

Internal note: "No entry in credits audit log" — manual override used

Sandra's Investigation Time

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Customer Relationship at Risk

- ▶ **£25K credit limit** (large account)

Capability 1: ETA Inquiries → 90% Automated

✗ BEFORE (Current)

11:14 Customer SMS: "Where is order AX-771-3344?"

↓ Agent queries CRM

↓ Agent calls Dispatch for GPS

↓ **5 min wait**

11:16 Agent: "On route 028. ETA 13:00-17:00."

11:17 Customer: "4 hour window, be more specific?"

↓ **5 min wait**

11:24 Agent: "Best guess 14:00-15:00."

Total: 11 minutes

✓ AFTER (Agent)

11:14 Customer SMS: "Where is order AX-771-3344?"

↓ Agent queries CRM + GPS + Traffic

↓ Agent calculates precision ETA

↓ **<30 sec**

11:14 Agent: "Based on driver location (Watford), your delivery is estimated **14:00-14:30** today. Traffic: moderate. I'll notify you when driver is nearby."

Total: <30 seconds

What We're NOT Doing

- ▶ ✗ Building a conversational chatbot (customers hated those)
- ▶ ✗ Replacing Customer Ops team
- ▶ ✗ Handling complex inquiries (complaints, exceptions)

Capability 2: Billing Disputes → 64% Faster

✗ Sandra's Current Workflow (28 min)

1. ▶ Read customer email (2 min)
2. ▶ Query Aurum for invoice (5 min)
3. ▶ Query fuel surcharge detail (3 min)
4. ▶ Check CRM customer history (4 min)
5. ▶ Check delivery logs for damage (4 min)
6. ▶ Review receivables aging (2 min)
7. ▶ **Decide credit amount (5 min) ← Her judgment**
8. ▶ Draft email to customer (3 min)

✓ Agent-Assisted Workflow (8 min)

1. ▶ **Agent aggregates data (2 min)**
Queries 4 systems in parallel
2. ▶ **Agent presents summary to Sandra**
Invoice, damage claim, history, recommendation
3. ▶ **Sandra reviews (2 min)**
4. ▶ **Sandra decides (1 min) ← Her judgment**
5. ▶ **Agent drafts email (1 min)**
6. ▶ **Sandra approves, agent logs (2 min)**

Agent Investigation Summary (Example)

Dispute: INV-2026-04318, Hayes & Sons

Invoice: £3,816 total, £340 fuel surcharge (Route R-008, Tier T3)

Damage Claim: Driver noted "pallet leaning" in delivery log

Customer History: 2 prior FUEL_SURCH_DAMAGE disputes (90 days)

Capability 3: Exception Triage → Unblock Drivers

Current Problem (From Voicemail)

Mark Petrov (Driver, Route 042) at Stein-Allen:

- Pallet leaning, recipient refuses
- Driver uncertain: damaged or just cosmetic?
- Calls Sandra → **line busy**
- Driver parked, **6 deliveries waiting**
- Wait time: **20+ minutes** for callback

Agent-Assisted Workflow

60% Routine Cases (Agent-Led)

- Package value <£500
- Customer tier: STANDARD (not VIP)
- Refusal reason: cosmetic/timing

Agent Decision: "Return to depot"

Driver receives instruction: <2 min

40% Complex Cases (Sandra Decides)

- Package value >£500
- Customer tier: VIP (Stein-Allen)
- Structural damage (safety risk)

Agent Escalates: "Hold position, dispatcher reviewing. ETA 5 min."

The Proof: Prove It Works Before Committing

Phase 1A: Pilot (Months 1-2) — £0 Risk

- ▶ Scope: 50 ETA inquiries/day (12.5% of volume), scheduled window only
- ▶ Team: 3 Customer Ops agents volunteer, review agent responses
- ▶ Success: 80% of responses approved without modification
- ▶ **Decision Point: End of Month 2 → Scale or Stop**

Phase 1B: Scale ETA (Month 3)

- ▶ Scope: 400 inquiries/day (100%), precision ETA (GPS + traffic)
- ▶ Success: 85-90% deflection, <30 sec response, >4.0/5 CSAT, >90% accuracy
- ▶ **Decision Point: End of Month 3 → Proceed to Phase 2 or Stop**

Phase 2: Billing Disputes (Months 4-6)

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▶ Scope: 60 disputes/day, agent investigates, Sandra approves

+ Operational efficiencies: **+£50K** (fewer repeat contacts)

What We're NOT Promising (Learning from Past Failures)

What This Is NOT

- ▶ **X Not a chatbot**
Structured inquiries only (ETA, billing). No open-ended conversations.
- ▶ **X Not replacing your team**
35 FTE stays 35 FTE. Freed capacity absorbs growth.
- ▶ **X Not touching Aurum**
We accept T-1 lag, 48-hour tickets. Work around it, not through it.
- ▶ **X Not 100% accurate**
ETA accuracy 90-95% target. Escalate when GPS stale or uncertain.
- ▶ **X Not zero oversight**
10% spot-checks weekly. Dispatcher workshops for Phase 3.

Learning from Your Past Failures

2024 Chatbot Failure

Why it failed: Too conversational, couldn't handle edge cases, customers felt unheard

Our design: Structured inquiries only. Immediate human escalation if customer replies "AGENT". Empathy phrases in templates.

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RPA Billing Recon Failure

Why it failed: Broke when Aurum schema changed quarterly. Silent failures.

Our design: Monitor CSV parse success daily. Flexible parsing

Your Decision: Proceed to Phase 1A Pilot?

"If it doesn't work in 2 months, we stop. No sunk cost fallacy."

If YES → What Happens Next

- ▶ **Next 2 weeks:** Build Phase 1A (ETA scheduled window, SMS channel)
- ▶ **Week 3:** Your 3 Customer Ops agents volunteer (4-week pilot)
- ▶ **Weeks 3-6:** Pilot runs (50 inquiries/day, agents review before sending)
- ▶ **Weekly reviews:** Progress updates, honest about what's working and what's not
- ▶ **End of Month 2:** Your Decision Point 2 → Scale to Phase 1B or Stop

If NO → What Needs to Change?

- ▶ Smaller pilot? (1 agent, 2 weeks, 20 inquiries/day)

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- ▶ Different work stream? (Billing disputes instead of ETA inquiries)

Anticipated Questions

1. What if GPS API isn't available from Dispatch/IT?

Answer: Phase 1A works without GPS (scheduled window only, 50% deflection). Phase 1B deferred until GPS API access negotiated. We prove value first (Phase 1A), then negotiate infrastructure (GPS for Phase 1B).

2. What if dispatchers resist Phase 3 (exception triage)?

Answer: We don't proceed to Phase 3 unless dispatcher workshops succeed. Sandra must codify heuristics and approve agent logic. If resistance persists, we stop Phase 3 — Phases 1-2 (ETA + billing) already deliver £374K annual value.

3. What if the agent gives wrong ETAs and customers complain?

Answer: We track accuracy weekly (spot-check agent ETA vs actual delivery time). Target: >90% accurate (± 30 min). If accuracy drops <85% for 2 weeks, we tune agent logic (widen ETA windows, adjust traffic heuristics). Agent escalates when GPS stale (>30 min) or uncertain — doesn't guess.

4. What's the total cost? How long to payback?

Why This Is "Something That Actually Works"

✓ Proves Value Quickly

Phase 1A is 2 months, not 18. You'll see 50 inquiries/day deflected in Week 4. If it doesn't work, we stop. No sunk cost fallacy.

✓ Doesn't Break with Changes

Not integrating with Aurum (batch is fine). If GPS goes down, agent falls back to scheduled window. If Aurum schema changes, agent alerts IT (doesn't silently break like RPA).

✓ Augments Your Team

Sandra decides credit amounts. Dispatchers handle VIP exceptions. Agent handles the 60-70% routine work — lookups, data gathering, pattern-based triage.

✓ Delivers on Benchmark

£437K Year 1, £627K Year 2. Proportional to competitor's £1.2M (at 2x your scale). Conservative — not counting Phase 4 (dispatch optimization) or proactive outreach.

"Sarah, you decide every 2 months whether to continue or stop.

If Phase 1A doesn't work, we stop. You've lost 2 months of pilot time. That's it.

No million-pound contract. No 18-month implementation.

Thank You

Ready to answer your questions and discuss next steps

Decision 1: Proceed to Phase 1A Pilot?

Timeline: 2-week build, 4-week pilot, Decision Point at Month 2

Your Call: Scale, Tune, or Stop